



VertiGO!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 701 July 2007 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards.

Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

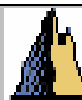


Mike Courtney, Ball Pass



Section Night 2 July 2007: Erik Bradshaw:

“It started as a simple adventure – ski tour from Manali along the Himalaya to the starting point of the Ganges – about 300km. However, the biggest snow year in memory, bad weather, running out of food, being saved by snow-bound villages led to a great adventure. Even the local Buddhist monastery had never heard of people coming over the passes in winter and they have been there thousands of years!”



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



The adventures of Merewyn and Josh

For the moment we are back in Calgary, more bike maintenance, we are now using 2 part epoxy to hold things together and stop them leaking. The quick BC tour turned into an extended trip across BC and back through Washington, Idaho and Montana. Lots of really great roads - with corners! Josh has nearly worn the flat spot off his rear tire... or was that me when I was riding it?

Lots of pics and the full story on the blog now:

<http://placebojim.blogspot.com>

In a few days we will head off again, think of us as we are crossing the great plains, boring boring boring.

Merewyn Ellis



MORE FROM MIKE! Mt Buffalo

Mt Buffalo is the premier Granite climbing area in Australia. It covers a huge area, comprising a 300m deep gorge that cleaves into the side of the mountain with sheer intimidating sides, and a variety of steep slabby domes and outcrops that perch on the top. The area is rich in climbing history, with the first routes being done in the 1930's. Buffalo has a reputation as being a place that humbles climbers. Perhaps this is due to the coarseness of the granite, which will chew your skin off if you don't treat it with respect. Or perhaps it's because the carrot bolts on the slabs are so run out. Or maybe it's the dramatic and committing abseil into the overhanging gorge walls that do it. Whatever it is that give Buffalo its aura, it makes Buffalo well worth a visit, especially if you know Arapiles inside out!

Location: Victoria, about 4 hours drive North West of Melbourne. The camp and climbing areas are all located on the top of the Mountain, a windy 30 minute drive from the valley below. The area is a popular tourist destination, so most climbing areas are accessed by short well maintained tracks.

Climbing: The gorge and surrounding areas all host trad and bolted routes, on gnarly cracks and slabs, from 30 to 300m long. Buffalo is also the home of Australia's aid climbing scene (such as it is now days). The bolts are usually carrots, so pick up some hangers in Melbourne. If abseiling into the gorge, protect your rope as the rock is sharp.

Grades: 9 – 32. Knock a grade or two off when you first arrive, as the climbs are generally solid at the grade. The saying goes that "If you climb in gyms, add 5 grades, if you climbed in the 70's take 5 off"! The slabs have a well earned reputation as being very run out too.

Season: Buffalo is in the Alpine region. Summer is perfect (when Arapiles and Grampians are sweltering). Due to the size of Buffalo you can always find a shady climb. Winter is cold; when it snows in Australia, it snows here first.

Accommodation: Lake Catani campsite is in the middle of the climbing areas, and is a great DOC like camping ground, with hot showers. The small lake offers great swimming in summer. The camp is popular with the general public during holidays, so book ahead at these times. Otherwise there are many campsites on the valley floor, a 30min drive away.

Services: Stock up on climbing gear and groceries on the way out of Melbourne. The last fuel stop is the little town of Myrtleford, which also has a supermarket. The water at camp is untreated but seems okay.

Guidebook: The VCC (Victorian Climbing Club) have recently published an excellent guide to Buffalo; 'Mt Buffalo: a rock-climbers guide. Edition 5', Kevin Lindorff & Simon Murray, 2006, VCC, Melbourne. Be aware that this ain't Arapiles; finding your climb in some areas will take a little time. Some of the best climbs are off the tourist tracks a little! It is

worth getting in touch with the VCC, to see if you can organise a trip with someone who knows the area.

Restday Activities: The valley below Buffalo is earning a well deserved reputation as a gourmet region. Fine wines and food await – don't miss the King River Café, and The Berry Farm. There are pleasant alpine walks across the alpine plateau on the Mt, and cross country skiing in the winter.

References: www.chockstone.org is the most frequented and active Australian climbing website. Here you can get the answer to any climbing/ Buffalo related question.
www.parkweb.vic.gov.au for camping info. www.vicclimb.org.au for the VCC.

And Remember: I'm not a fan of taping up for jamming, but I tape up to climb at Buffalo! This place is a slab and crack climbers paradise.

Mike O'Brien



HANGDOG BOULDERING SERIES

Details at:

<http://www.topadventures.co.nz/hangdog/wbs2007.html>



DISTARGHIL SAR FUND

The Wellington Section committee is now calling for applications for the Distaghil Sar Award. Applications technically closed 1st June 2007 (but late applications will be considered on their merits).

Find out more about the Distaghil Sar Award and what you need to include in your application by emailing Garth London (gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz)

Send your application in writing to:

DSF Fund Administrators, P.O. Box 1628 Wellington

Alternatively email to dsfadmin@nzalpine.wellington



Avalanche Transceivers

You are probably all aware that Mainly Tramping has (sadly) closed its doors. People may now be wondering where to hire avalanche transceivers from.

The eight transceivers that were being administered by Mainly Tramping have now been relocated to Bivouac. We are very grateful that Bivouac have offered to work with the Wellington Avalanche Transceiver Trust to hire out some of our transceivers.

The remaining transceivers owned by the Avo Trust are still available where they've always been, at HangDog and Ski & Camp. We are also grateful for their continuing support.

The Avalanche Trust has 21 "DTS TRACKER" transceivers available in the Wellington area, and all can be hired at any of these stores.

Pete de Joux, Sean Comber, Rachael Schmidt, Nigel Seebeck (Trustees)



Looking for HOM artefacts

From Head Office: "Due to the number of items of gear donated to the NZAC since the opening of the new Home of Mountaineering, we would like to find a couple of members with some experience regarding storage and display of historical equipment. Ideally we would like to have someone local who is able to advise the Club on items already stored in the Home of Mountaineering Library and also to develop a plan on how to handle future donations, taking into account the limitations for storage and display that are presently available.

Even if you are unable to assist personally, but may know of someone who would be willing to give us some advice, it would be greatly appreciated. Please contact Margaret at the National Office in Christchurch, Margaret (at) alpineclub.org.nz"

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Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



RARE COPIES NZAC JOURNALS – MEMBERS ONLY

From Head Office: “After careful sorting by our volunteer, Jenny Harlow, the NZAC has managed to fill all the spaces in its Archived sets of NZAC Alpine Journals. This has left us with a limited surplus of copies from 1892 through to the present day.

To raise funds for much needed repairs to some of our more rare and valuable Library books, it has been decided to offer members the opportunity to obtain these surplus Journals for their collections. Due to the variety of conditions and years available, it will be easiest if you submit a list of the Journals you are interested in, to Margaret at the National Office. She will then advise on the status and suggested price for you. Postage will be extra and dependent on the size and destination of the order. Offer open while stocks last.”

Please email Margaret (at) alpineclub.org.nz



THE HERMITAGE

From the Hermitage General Manager: "The Hermitage is to fund the construction of a Museum for the Aoraki Mount Cook Museum Trust as part of the construction of The Sir Edmund Hillary Alpine Centre to be completed by Christmas 2007. In addition The Hermitage has agreed to fund staffing for the on-going management of the museum and \$150,000 + GST for initial displays. On opening, unless more funds are raised for displays, approx 2/3rds of the Museum area will remain un-occupied for future development and displays. It is the wish of the Museum Trust to try and raise an additional \$200,000 to allow more of the museum space to be commissioned from day one. In addition the Trust is still interested in gathering artifacts of historical importance to the Mount Cook Region. As with many museums, many items will be in storage most of the time but it is important to have these items available for research, periodical displays and to have them preserved for future generations. Donations to this worthy cause can be made out to: The Aoraki/Mt Cook Museum Trust, C/- The Hermitage Hotel, Private Bag, Mount Cook National Park 7946"



SCARPA 2007 SKI MOUNTAINEERING RACES

A brand new alpine challenge, the Scarpa 2007 NZ ski mountaineering race series, will be run this winter at four different ski resorts in the North and South Islands.

A ski mountaineering race is just that, using mountaineering, touring and skiing skills to ascend and descend a marked course through challenging winter alpine terrain. It sounds like hard work, and it is, but it's also a lot of fun and a great personal satisfaction.

Rather like entering your first mountain bike race, and it gives a huge boost to your recreational touring.

There are going to be recreational and race classes and participation is the name of the game. It's achievable to anyone with good basic mountaineering and skiing skills. Ski, telemark, splitboard and snowshoe/board touring setups are all welcome.

The four events will be held at Turoa, Ohau, Temple Basin and Craigieburn. We have some pretty good prizes lined up from our sponsors and NZAC members will get a discount on entry fees.

Check out the brand spanking new website... www.skimonz.com and get into what will be a new and enjoyably different day out for the back country community.

Craig Martella, Nelson Marlborough Section

With the up coming Scarpa Ski Mountaineering Race Series this winter there will be some free ski mountaineering race video/slide shows around the South Island.

For those in the southern lakes there will be shows in Queenstown at R&R Sports, 20th June and in Wanaka at Mainly Tramping, 21st June, as well as Christchurch at R&R Sports, 26 th June.

The first 5 people in the door at each video/slide show will receive free entry to one of the races of their choice (not including lift ticket, if required)

The shows will have videos form the 2006 world ski mountaineering world champs, world cup races in North America and tutorial videos on how to become a faster back country skier.

For more info e-mail <<mailto:nzinfo@skimountaineering.org>> nzinfo@skimountaineering.org or go to www.skimonz.com



FOR SALE/WANTED TO BUY



FOR SALE

Black Diamond sabertooth pro crampons

In very good condition, come with anti balling plates, only 1 1/2 seasons use, sell for \$190.

Cactus waterproof dreadnought pants Size large, excellent condition, hardly used, tons of features
sell \$180

Contact Nathan Watson on 027 343 8121 or naw96@student.cpit.ac.nz



WANTED

Please can you help? I'm looking for snow sports and mountaineering equipment for an educational display.

I will consider anything in any condition – Please don't throw out our history we need to show our children what it was like.

Please get in touch if you have mountaineering, tramping, ski, and snowboard related products. By this I mean Skis, boots, Snow boards, books, ice axes, packs, crampons, stamps, movies, movie footage – professional or amateur, photos – professional or amateur, clothing, posters, diaries knitting patterns etc... essentially anything to do with Snowsports and the mountains of any age or condition. You might even have some good stories to tell, please let me know.

Contact Gerald Davies, PO Box 657, WANAKA, 021 946 066, geraldldavies@xtra.co.nz



Lose the Weight, Not the Performance

Ski Trab, a small, 60yr old, family owned ski company from Bormio, Italy, world renowned for producing light weight, high performance and high quality skis is finally available in NZ.

Ski mountaineering racers, mountain guides, ski patrollers and back country enthusiasts throughout Europe and North America have for years "lost the weight, but not the performance" and now New Zealand skiers can too.

This are the lightest skis on the NZ market and at the 2007 winter special intro price the cheapest to.

New Zealand Alpine Club members receive a further discount on the 2007 winter special intro price

Duo FreeRando

Dimensions: 112/110-79-96

Weight:1250gr/164cm (per ski)

Sizes(cm):157, 164, 171, 178

RRP \$1199, 2007 winter special intro price-\$999

NZAC member price \$899!

Stelvio FreeRide

Dimensions: 117/115-84-105
Weight:1610/171cm (per ski)
Sizes(cm):164, 171, 178, 185
RRP\$1199, 2007 winter special intro price-\$999
NZAC member price \$899!

Go to www.iclimb.co.nz
or for a full price list and catalogue e-mail grant@skimountaineering.org



CAN YOU HELP?

“I am hoping you will be able to help me.

I am off to Pakistan at the end of July to climb Mt Spantik in the Karakoram (7027m).

I am trying to locate someone who may have a pair of 8000meter boots I can hire and I thought you may be able to point me in the correct direction for this.I have emailed Dennis at the central NI club but nothing available there.So I am trying a bit further afield.

Because of severe frost nip 5 years ago I now find my toes get very cold very easily and I don't want to trust my Plastics on this trip.

Again I hope you will be able to help.

The size I am requiring will need to be a minimum of 9.and a half or 43.

Thank you for your time.

Mike Cosgrove

Kihikihi

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heat and stretch nylon fibres to align molecules

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mountaineering tent
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2-person single skin
hiking tent
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www.iclimb.co.nz



OVER 70'S TRAVEL INSURANCE

From Head Office: "Thanks to the enquiries of Trevor Chinn, we have approached our travel insurance provider on behalf of our ever-adventurous, over 70 year old climbers. They have come back with permanent endorsement to now cover NZAC members between the ages of 70-75yrs for any extra 10% premium. They will also consider 76 year+ applications on a case-by-case basis. "

Please see this webpage for more travel insurance information:

<http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=23>



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

Trips for the Calendar for 2007 so far...

20-22Jul - Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and up to 2-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

24-26Aug - Ruapehu South - Girdlestone and Taurangi – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and up to 2-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Taurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Taurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

21-23Sep - Egmont - via Taurangi lodge – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and up to 2-3 years experience

We will leave early on Friday afternoon (4pm) to North Egmont car park, from where we will tramp up to Taurangi Lodge (1.5h) arriving ca. 11pm. On Saturday we will ascend Egmont (2518m) via the Lizard, returning to the lodge for the evening. On Sunday we will explore the rock walls of Warwick Castle (bring a rope for this trip) towards the eastern side before returning to the car park. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

19-22Oct - Cupola - Nelson Lakes – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and up to 2-3 years experience

Labour Weekend trip - time for a bit of South Island powder snow and true alpine peaks experience! We will take the ferry then hire car to Nelson Lakes on Friday night, staying in the backpackers at St Arnaud. On Saturday we will take the water taxi to the far end of Lake Rotoiti, and then tramp up to Cupola Hut (7h). On Sunday we will climb Cupola, return and descend to John Tait Hut. Monday is for the walk out, water taxi, ferry back to Wellington. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

9-12Nov - Mueller Hut- Leader = Rachael Schmidt/Garth London - Level = AIC Graduate and up to 2-3 years experience

Most likely we will be flying to Christchurch on Friday night then driving to Mt Cook Village (arriving ca. 11pm) staying at Unwin Hut. Otherwise some ferry/drive combination is envisaged. A number of options are possible including Barron Saddle Hut, and Mts Olivier, Kitchener and Sealy. Details to come. Contact Garth gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz or Rachael rs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

22Dec07 – 6Jan08 – Xmas Trip – Destination TBA – Leader TBA

Yes folks, this ones the biggie! 15 days in-country, multiple moderate grade peaks. Destination – somewhere in the South Island, south of Arthurs Pass.

8-10Feb – Taranaki Rock – Leader = James Wright

Weekend trip to climb the rock on Mt Taranaki. Most likely we will be based from Tahurangi lodge on the Northern Slopes. Multiple rock routes on various pillars and outcrops including Humphries Castle. Contact James Wright at james.wright@xtra.co.nz or call at (04) 232-7748 or (027) 4725-561.



MOVED HOUSE?

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office.

You can contact:

Margaret McMahon
National Administrator
email margaret@alpineclub.org.nz

NZAC
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595
FAX (03) 337 7594)



Bored at work?

Check out www.mountainz.co.nz

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/taranaki.html>

Central NI Volcanoes from Taupo

<http://www.taupodc.govt.nz/AboutTaupoDistrict/WebCam.htm>

Mount Ngauruhoe

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/ngauruhoe.html>

Mount Ruapehu – from Chateau

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/ruapehu.html>

Mount Ruapehu – from Ohakune

<http://www.unique-art-gallery.com/gallery/webcaml.htm>

Tararua from Wellington

<http://www.wn.co.nz/cameras/cam01.php>

Nelson Lakes

<http://www.snow.co.nz/clients/nelsonlakes/webcam.asp>

Castle Hill Basin

<http://www.castlehill.net.nz/webcam.htm>

Mt Cook

<http://www.alpineguides.co.nz/popup/cam.htm>

Two Thumb range & Multi Brun (east)

<http://www.tekapotourism.com/webcam.htm>

Aspiring

http://www.lakewanaka.co.nz/index.cfm/web_cam/

Queenstown

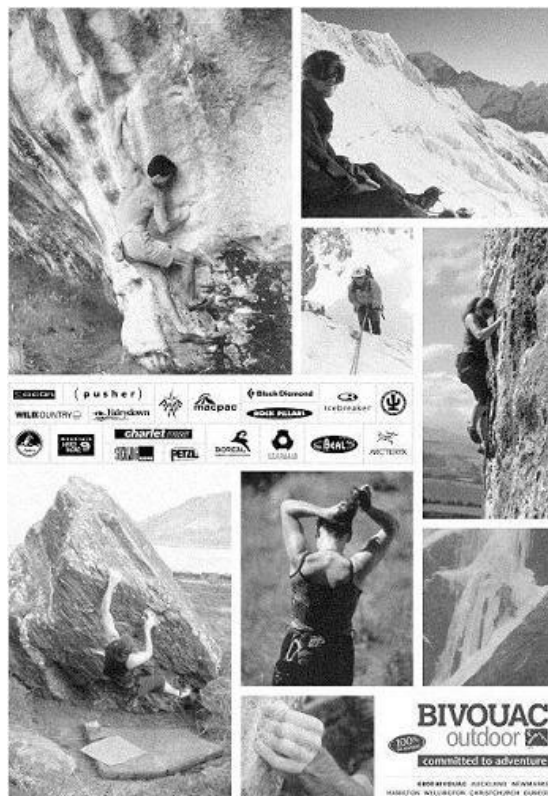
<http://www.skyline.co.nz/queenstown/webcam/>

Scott Base

<http://www.antarcticanz.govt.nz/education/2568>

Allsorts of others at

<http://www.enzed.com/cam.html>

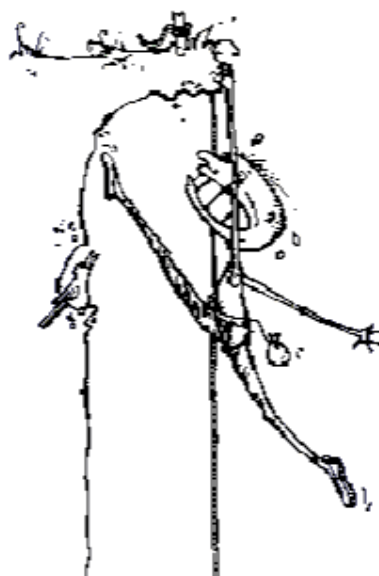




Wellington Section Directory: 2007 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Jennifer Brown	JB2	027 292 0903
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	475 8453 <i>or</i> 021 503 097
National Representative	Jennifer Brown and James Wright	JB2 <i>or</i> JW	N/A
	Garth London and Judy Reid	GL <i>or</i> JR	(04) 479 2984 (Garth)
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	(04) 494 5643
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	Rachael Schmidt	RS	(04) 494 5643
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	(04) 976 3365
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
Newsletter Editor	Rachael Schmidt	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> RS	(04) 474 5643
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Judy Reid	JR	N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

